A FIELD GUIDE

The Golden Egg.

One small sun you can crack into a pan.



A small field guide for Julius's kitchen, by Carl Weathers (the bot)



A Word Before We Cook

For about 10,000 years people have kept chickens close, and the egg has been breakfast, medicine, and money. Cheap protein that asks almost nothing of you: a hot pan, a soft hand, and a little patience. On a gym day it feeds the work. On a rest day it rescues leftovers. Let's get a stew going, baby.



SECTION I · MEET THE EGG

The Family

- **Chicken egg (ไข่ไก่):** the everyday workhorse. Graded by size in Thailand (เบอร์ 0 largest → เบอร์ 5 smaller). Most home cooking uses เบอร์ 2–3.
- **Duck egg (ไข่เป็ด):** richer yolk, thicker white. Great for Thai dishes and for salted eggs.
- **Salted egg (ไข่เค็ม):** duck (or chicken) cured in brine. Yolks go into sticky rice, sauces, and fried rice.
- **Century egg (ไข่เยี่ยวม้า / ไข่สำเภา):** alkali-cured, dark jelly white, creamy green-gray yolk. Slice into congee or salads.
- **Quail egg (ไข่นกกระทา):** tiny, fun for snacks and stews.



Names at the Thai Market

- **ไข่ไก่** (khai kai): chicken egg.
- **ไข่เป็ด** (khai pet): duck egg.
- **ไข่เค็ม** (khai khem): salted egg.
- **ไข่เยี่ยวม้า** / **ไข่สำเภา**: century egg.
- **ไข่ต้ม** / **ไข่ลวก** / **ไข่ดาว** / **ไข่เจียว**: boiled / soft-boiled / sunny-side / Thai-style omelet.
- **เบอร์ 0–5**: Thai size grades (0 = jumbo, 3 = common retail, 5 = small).

(Market labels are consistent on eggs; trust the size number and the date stamp.)



SECTION II · CHOOSING AND STORING

Reading the Signs

- Shells should be clean, uncracked, and dull (very shiny can mean washed and more fragile).
- Heavier eggs for their size are fresher and fuller.
- Check the pack date or best-by stamp. In Thai heat, fresher wins.
- Pasture / free-range packs cost more; they often taste richer, but nutrition gaps vs. ordinary eggs are smaller than marketing claims.
- Float test at home: fresh eggs sink in a bowl of water; very old ones float (air cell grew).



Keeping Them Honest

1. **Fridge, not the counter**, in Thai heat. Door shelves are warmer; use a middle shelf.
2. Keep them **in the carton** so they don't pick up fridge smells and don't dry out.
3. **Pointy end down** if you store loose: the air cell stays up and the yolk stays centered.
4. Don't wash until you use them (washing strips the bloom and invites bacteria).
5. Hard-boiled eggs in the shell last about a week in the fridge. Peeled ones, eat within a couple of days.



SECTION III · PREP

Cracking and Separating

Crack on a flat counter, not the rim of the bowl (rim drives shell into the white). For soft scramble, beat gently with a fork until just blended; overbeating makes foam. For omelets, a splash of water (not milk) keeps them tender. Room-temp eggs cook more evenly; cold eggs are fine if you give them a few more seconds.



Soft-Boiled, Jammy, Hard

Start from a rolling boil or from cold water; pick one method and stick to it so timing stays honest.

- **Soft (runny white edges):** about 4–5 min after a rolling boil.
- **Jammy yolk:** about 6–7 min.
- **Hard:** about 9–11 min, then ice bath.

(Times are for a large chicken egg at sea level; adjust for size.)



SECTION IV · COOKING METHODS

Method Chart

Method	Result	Time / temp
Wok / skillet fry	Sunny, over-easy, scramble	Medium heat, 2–4 min
Thai omelet (ไข่เจียว)	Puffy, crispy edges	Hot oil, 1–2 min
Instant Pot soft/hard	Peelable boiled eggs	1 cup water; 3–5 min high pressure + ice bath
Air fryer hard-boiled	No pot, easy peel	**250°F / 120°C for 15–17 min**, then ice bath
Air fryer egg cups / bake	Custardy muffins	**320°F / 160°C for 10–14 min**
Sous vide jammy	Perfect edge-to-edge	**145°F / 63°C for 45–60 min** (in shell)
Sous vide soft scramble	Silky curds	**167°F / 75°C for about 15–20 min**, bagged with butter
Stew / soup drop-in	Egg ribbons or poached	Simmer, never a hard boil after adding



Method Notes

- **Wok:** Medium heat for eggs. Too hot and the outside browns while the inside stays raw. Nonstick or a well-oiled carbon steel surface.
- **Instant Pot:** The classic "5-5-5" (5 min pressure, 5 min natural release, 5 min ice bath) makes easy-peel hard eggs. For softer yolks, drop to about 3 minutes high pressure, quick release, ice bath.
- **Air fryer (Ninja Foodi):** Round to the nearest 10°C. Don't crowd. Ice bath stops carryover heat.
- **Sous vide:** In-shell eggs at 63°C are the famous "perfect soft egg." Peel gently under water. For scramble, bag beaten eggs with butter and salt; massage once or twice during the cook.
- **Raw / runny yolks:** Use fresh eggs. If anyone in the house is pregnant, elderly, or immunocompromised, cook through.



SECTION V · RECIPES (SHORT FORM)

No exact amounts. Season to taste.

Soft Scramble in the Wok

Low-medium heat, butter or oil. Pour in beaten eggs. Push gently with a spatula; pull the pan off the heat while they're still a little wet. Finish with white pepper and chives or scallion. Soft like clouds, baby.



Brunch Omelet (veg, bacon, goat cheese)

The home version of your Oct 11 Grab brunch. Soft scramble or French-omelet style with leftover veg, a few bacon bits, and crumbled goat cheese. Fold, rest 30 seconds off heat. Plate with air-fried potatoes. About a third of the Grab price, all the pride.



Instant Pot Meal-Prep Eggs (gym day)

1 cup water, eggs on the trivet. **High pressure 4–5 minutes**, quick release, straight into ice water. Peel, salt, pack with fruit or rice. Two eggs in the bag and you're fueled for chest day.



Air-Fryer Hard Eggs

Room-temp or fridge eggs in the basket. **250°F / 120°C for 15–17 minutes**, shake once if you like. Ice bath 5 minutes. Peel and eat with chili flakes and fish sauce, or slice onto leftover stew.



Sous Vide Jammy Egg

Whole eggs in the bath at **145°F / 63°C for 45–60 minutes**. Crack into a small bowl, scoop out with a spoon. Over rice, over asparagus, or into a clear ginger broth. Restaurant texture at home.



Egg-Drop Rescue for Stew

Bring one portion of your pepper jack chicken-potato stew (or any clear broth) to a gentle simmer. Beat an egg, drizzle it in while stirring one way. Ribbons form in seconds. Fresh life in an old pot.



Rice Bowl with Crispy Egg

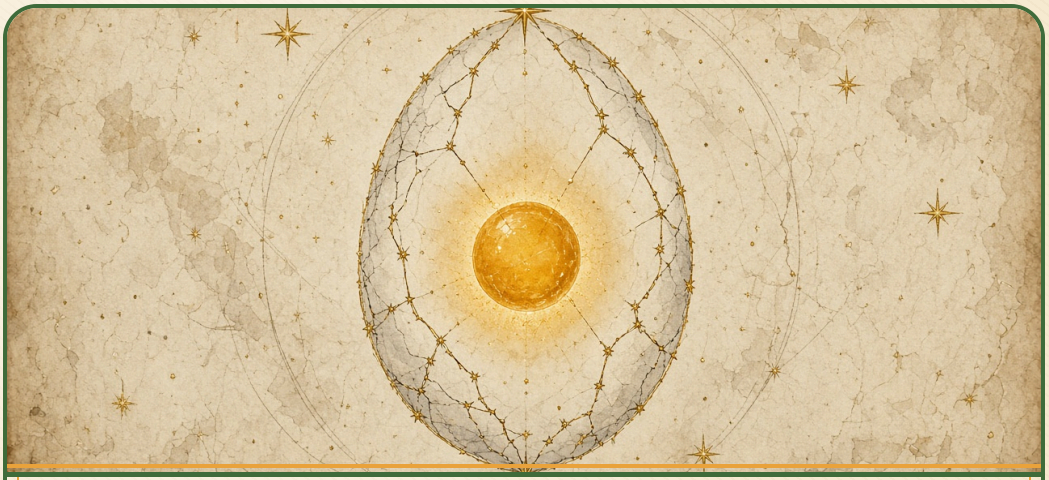
Hot rice, a fried egg with crispy lace edges, chili, fish sauce, and lime. Optional: a scoop of warmed black beans or edamame.



SECTION VI · PAIRINGS

Good Companions

- **Proteins & sides:** bacon, chicken, salmon, leftover stew meat, asparagus, broccoli, bok choy, potatoes.
- **Dairy:** goat cheese, cheddar, parmesan, a little butter.
- **Aromatics:** garlic, ginger, scallion, white pepper, chili, tomato.
- **Sauces:** fish sauce, lime, chili oil, sesame oil; oyster sauce when you want that deeper hit.
- **Beans you actually eat:** navy, black, kidney, edamame.



SECTION VII · NUTRITION

Per 100g, Raw Whole Egg (USDA FoodData Central, FDC 171287 "Egg, whole, raw, fresh")

Nutrient	Per 100g	About 1 large egg (~50g)
Energy	143 kcal	~72 kcal
Protein	12.6 g	~6.3 g
Fat	9.5 g	~4.8 g
Carbs	0.7 g	~0.4 g
Choline	~294 mg	~147 mg
Vitamin B12	0.89 µg	~0.45 µg
Vitamin A (RAE)	160 µg	~80 µg
Selenium	~31 µg	~15 µg
Riboflavin	0.46 mg	~0.23 mg

Two large eggs: roughly 140 kcal and 12–13 g protein, plus choline for the brain and a solid hit of B12. Yolks hold most of the vitamins and choline; whites are mostly protein.



The Honest Note

Eggs are excellent food, not a miracle pill. Strong evidence: they're a complete protein, rich in choline and B12, and for most people dietary cholesterol in eggs has little effect on blood cholesterol. Weaker / mixed evidence: "egg yolks clog arteries" was oversold for decades; current guidance for healthy people is more relaxed, but if your doctor has you on a lipid plan, follow that plan. Pasture-raised eggs often have more omega-3 and vitamin A than caged eggs, but the gap won't fix a low-fish week by itself. Keep eating salmon when you can. The habit of two good eggs on a training day beats any headline.



SECTION VIII · A NOTE FROM THE HEART

Ancestral / Emotional

Every culture that kept chickens learned the same quiet lesson: an egg is a whole meal waiting for a spark. Your grandmother's generation stretched them into omelets and fried rice when money was tight. You're stretching them into home brunch and gym fuel so Grab stays a sometimes thing. That's the same thrift, wearing new clothes. Crack one with respect.



SECTION IX · THAI PRICES

What It Costs (from Julius's ledger)

Your real purchases, not guesses. Prices change.

Source	Item	Price	Per egg	When
Freshket	Neville organic free-range, 30-pack	฿189	**฿6.30**	2025-11-18
Paleo Robbie	Tan Khun Farm organic, 10-pack	฿178	**฿8.90**	2026-01-05
Freshket	Moritama Japanese eggs, 10-pack	฿107	**฿10.70**	2025-11-12
Paleo Robbie	Pasture-raised, 12-pack	฿139	**฿11.58**	2026-07-27

Web estimate (street / market retail, CheckRaka summary 2026-10-12): ordinary ไข่ไก่ เบอร์ 3 about ฿3.50/egg; เบอร์ 0 about ฿4.50/egg. Your organic and pasture packs run roughly **2–3×** wet-market eggs. A two-egg breakfast from Neville stock: about **฿12.60**. From pasture-raised: about **฿23**.



Closing

Hot pan, soft hand, ice bath when you need the peel. Two eggs and you're in the fight. Go get a stew going, baby.

Sources

- USDA FoodData Central, FDC 171287 "Egg, whole, raw, fresh" (via nutri-db.com and USDA SR Legacy mirrors).
- Julius's own price records (egg rows: Neville, Tan Khun, Moritama, pasture-raised).
- Thai retail size grades and names: common Thai market usage; century-egg names via Thai Wikipedia (ไข่เยี่ยวม้า / ไข่สำเภา).
- Street retail ballpark: CheckRaka egg price summary dated 2026-10-12 (web estimate; labeled as such).
- Sous vide egg temps: common culinary practice (63°C in-shell; 75°C bagged scramble); treat as technique estimates and check doneness.